

WHAT DOES PROOF ACTUALLY AUTHORIZE?

From verified performance to consequence-specific execution authority.

PROOF DOES NOT AUTHORIZE ITSELF.

Proof supports propositions. Authority applies to consequences.

CLAIM	EVIDENCE	SCOPE	REALITY	AUTHORITY	CONSEQUENCE
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The governing question

Does this proposed consequence have sufficient Admissible Evidence, Applicable Authority, and Established Standing to become reality NOW?

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TA14 Authority Governance Institution

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1. The problem

The industry is getting better at proving that systems work. Commissioning records, pilots, semantic models, telemetry, analytics, AI recommendations, operator verification, and measured outcomes can all establish important facts. But proof of performance is not automatically proof of permission.

The consequence boundary begins when a proven proposition is used to justify an action that will change physical reality. At that point the question is no longer merely whether the evidence is credible. The question is whether the evidence, authority, standing, scope, and continuity are sufficient for *this* proposed consequence now.

The examination path

CLAIM	What exactly is being claimed?
EVIDENCE	What has actually been demonstrated?
SCOPE	What proposition does the evidence support, and under what conditions?
REALITY	Does the record still represent reality now?
CROSSING	What crossed the boundary, and what did not?
AUTHORITY	What authority and standing apply to this proposed consequence?
DETERMINATION	ALLOW, HOLD, DENY, or ESCALATE?
CONSEQUENCE	What became real, and what must become the next record?

Core restraint: An admissible input does not create an admissible output. Each proposed consequence must earn its own execution determination.

01 · THE CLAIM

Freeze the proposition. Installed, connected, interoperable, accurate, effective, safe, scalable, and authorized are different claims. A promise is the beginning of examination, not the end.

01

THE CLAIM

What exactly is being claimed?

Before examining proof, we must freeze the proposition being proved. Different claims require different evidence, scope, authority, and standing.



COMMON CLAIM TYPES	
	PERFORMANCE Will it reduce energy use or emissions? 
	COMFORT Will it improve occupant comfort? 
	OPERATIONAL Will it run autonomously or require fewer people? 
	SAFETY Will it operate safely under all conditions? 
	COST Will it lower total cost of ownership? 

KEY CLARIFICATIONS BEFORE EXAMINING PROOF

**WHAT?**
What exact outcome or capability is being asserted?

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**WHERE?**
Where is this supposed to apply?

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**WHEN?**
During what time period?

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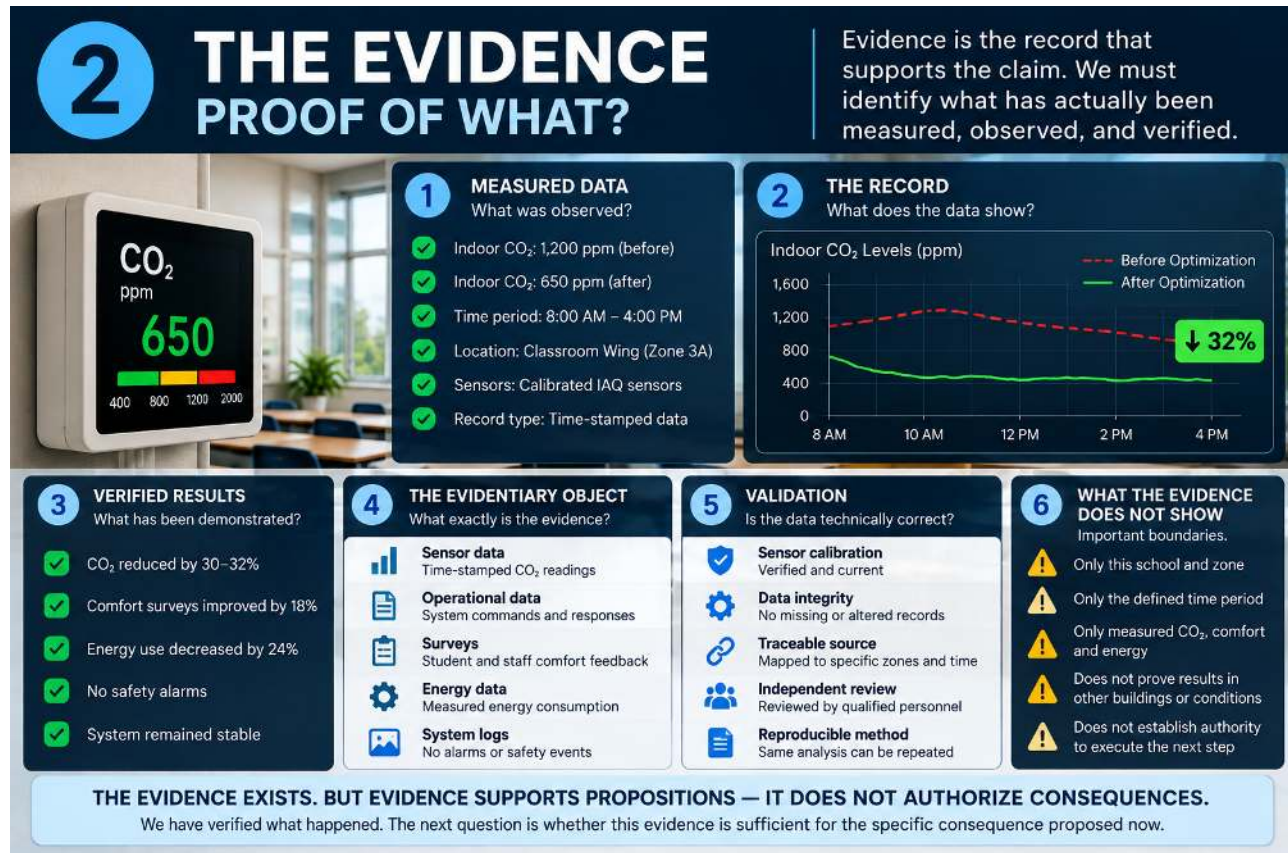
**UNDER WHAT CONDITIONS?**
Which conditions and limits apply?

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**FOR WHOM?**
Which occupants, spaces, or systems are included?

02 - THE EVIDENCE

Identify the evidentiary object. Preserve what was measured, how it was established, and what the record does not prove. Evidence supports propositions; it does not authorize consequences.



03 - THE SCOPE

Proof has boundaries. Preserve the asset, location, operating state, time window, conditions, exclusions, uncertainty, and applicability. Pilot does not automatically mean fleet.

3 THE SCOPE

WHERE THE CLAIM APPLIES

A claim only applies within a defined scope. We must establish exactly where the claim is supposed to work and where it does not.

DEFINING THE SCOPE

Where does the claim apply?

- ✓ Specific zones (e.g., Zone 3A)
- ✓ Defined time period (e.g., school hours)
- ✓ Identified conditions (e.g., normal operation)
- ✓ Specific systems (e.g., HVAC, controls)
- ✓ Stated objectives (e.g., reduce CO₂, improve comfort)
- ✗ Outside the scope:
 - Other buildings
 - Other zones not defined
 - Different time periods (e.g., evenings)
 - Non-HVAC systems (e.g., lighting)
 - Emergency or abnormal conditions
 - Claims of building-wide autonomy without validation

SYSTEM SCOPE

What systems are included?

- HVAC equipment
- Building automation system (BAS)
- Sensors (e.g., CO₂, temperature)
- Control logic for optimization

SPATIAL SCOPE

Where does it apply?

- Zone 3A – Classroom Wing
- Specific rooms and spaces
- Defined boundaries in BAS
- Not the entire building

TEMPORAL SCOPE

When does it apply?

SCHOOL HOURS
8:00 AM – 4:00 PM

- During school hours only
- Specific days (e.g., weekdays)
- Defined operating conditions
- Not during evenings, weekends, or holidays

CONDITIONAL SCOPE

Under what conditions?

Normal Operation

- System healthy
- Sensors operational
- No active alarms

- Normal operating conditions
- Sensors and data are valid
- No active safety alarms
- Not emergency or fault conditions

A CLAIM WITHOUT A DEFINED SCOPE CREATES FALSE EXPECTATIONS.

The same technology can produce different results in different places, times, systems, and conditions. Scope defines where the claim applies — and where it does not.

04 - THE REALITY

Verified once does not mean established now. Conditions change. Current execution requires sufficient continuity between the preserved record and physical reality at the moment of consequence.



05 · THE CROSSING

The crossing is not the permission. Identity, context, semantics, evidence, and validly derived authority may cross independently governed systems. Crossing alone does not establish execution permission.



Authority clarification. Authority may originate with an owner, institution, regulator, contract, policy, or other lawful source. Derived authority may pass through multiple entities. The execution boundary does not manufacture authority; it establishes whether the authority reaching it is valid and sufficient for the specific proposed consequence.

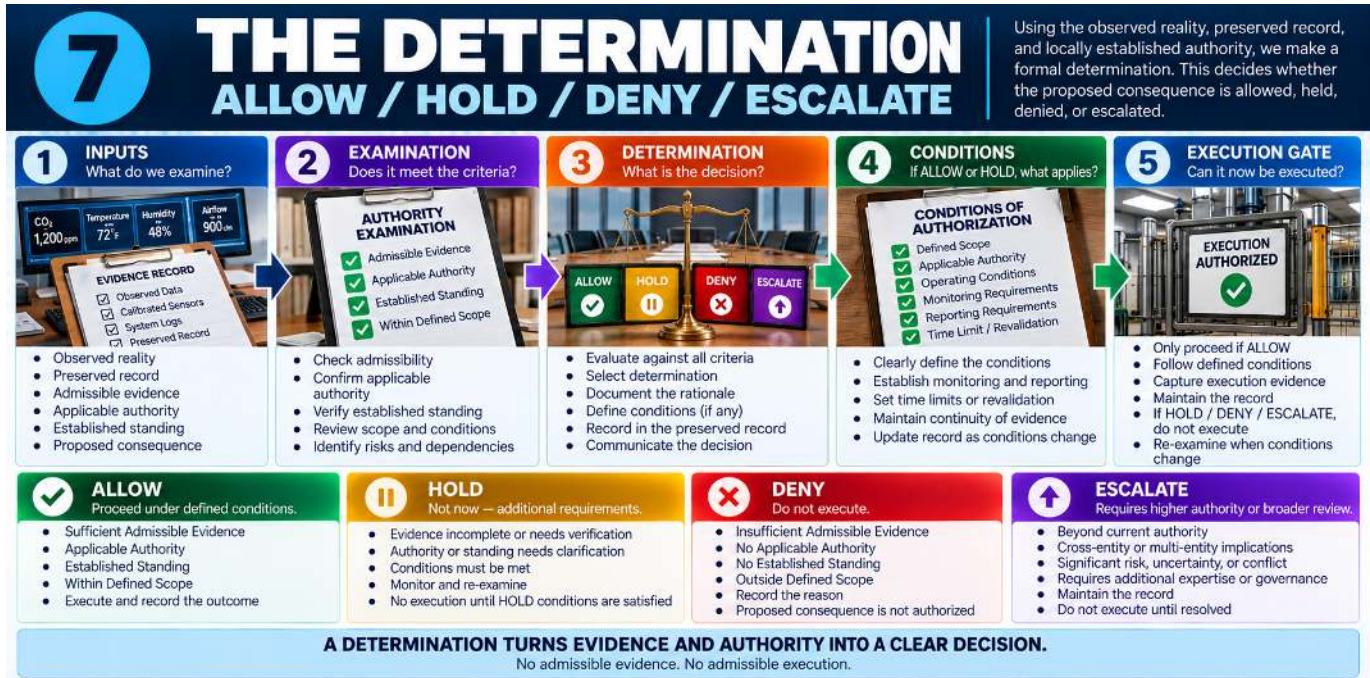
06 - THE AUTHORITY

Locally established does not mean locally originated. Authority may originate elsewhere and derived authority may traverse multiple entities. At execution, establish that the authority reaching the boundary is current, applicable, sufficient, and within scope.



07 · THE DETERMINATION

Governance must terminate operationally: ALLOW, HOLD, DENY, or ESCALATE. Uncertainty is not automatically HOLD; the disposition is consequence-specific.



08 · THE CONSEQUENCE

Execution produces an outcome. Verify what actually happened, preserve the outcome, compare it with the baseline, and establish the new reality and record from which the next consequence will be judged.



10. The consequence test

After claim, evidence, scope, continuity, crossing, and authority have been made visible, apply the governing question:

Does this proposed consequence have sufficient Admissible Evidence, Applicable Authority, and Established Standing to become reality NOW?

ALLOW	Required conditions for this consequence are sufficiently established.
HOLD	A required condition remains unresolved; do not silently infer it.
DENY	The proposed consequence is not admissible under the established evidence and authority.
ESCALATE	Another authority, standing, expertise, or decision boundary is required.

Important: uncertainty is not automatically HOLD. Missing information matters when the proposed consequence depends on a proposition that has not been sufficiently established.

No admissible evidence. No admissible execution.

11. Technical freeze

CORE	Proof does not authorize itself.
EVIDENCE	Proof supports propositions; preserve scope, conditions, and uncertainty.
CROSSING	The crossing is not the permission.
CONTINUITY	Verified once != established now.
AUTHORITY	Locally established != locally originated.
DERIVATION	Authority may originate elsewhere and derived authority may traverse multiple entities.
EXECUTION	Execution authority must still be established at the boundary where the proposed consequence becomes reality.
DISPOSITION	ALLOW / HOLD / DENY / ESCALATE
OUTCOME	Execution produces an outcome; the outcome becomes part of the new reality and record.

**BRING THE PROOF.
NAME THE PROPOSED CONSEQUENCE.
WALK THE BOUNDARY.**

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